

reborrow and reborrow, paying larger and larger amounts in interest into oblivion. And unfortunately, as one of the commenters on Oliver's video (which has 9 million views as of fall 2017) said, "Most people who get payday loans probably do not watch John Oliver."

It's tough in any case for this type of argument to persuade low-income people who are, let's say, desperate to pay off a car repair so they can get to their minimum wage job and feed their kids. People who take out these loans end up borrowing money from family, selling plasma, pawning possessions, and taking other desperate measures to pay back the loan that they could have done in the first place *instead* of taking out the loan.

Perhaps. But this point is made more disturbing in a fake commercial during Oliver's segment starring comedian Sarah Silverman in which she tells people thinking of taking out payday loans to do *anything else* to make money: sell sperm (not taking into account the emotional toll of perhaps having children in the world you don't know about or what happens when that kid comes looking for its dad via 23andMe or even if it's possible to donate if you have a disability or low sperm count); or shoplift (been there; not a point of pride for me); or sex work ("pee on people"), a job that is EXTREMELY vilified, can be dangerous, and could cause problems for future employment; or, her final suggestion, "to throw yourself in front of a rich guy's car." (I understand this segment is satire, but all of these suggestions made me feel icky and only highlighted for me why people choose the payday loan route and why poorer people feel misunderstood by liberal media.)

It reminded me of a very sad comical Instagram post by @lineofpepsi that asked "Are you broke?" and then listed options like selling your sperm for \$100, eggs for \$8,000, bone marrow for \$3,000, and then, growing increasingly dark, your corneas for \$21,000, your lungs for \$295,000, and your heart for \$607,000. (The user was joking. Sort of.)

"There's this implicit voice saying if only they acted like me, middle-class white woman with a college education, then they'd make a better decision," Servon said. But in her experience, the check casher was less expensive and more transparent and gave customers more personal service than the bank. Payday lenders might be "more transparent" in Servon's opinion, but that doesn't mean